collect the data regarding rainfall of the region. Then he will summarize the collected data in some table or diagram to show the desired results.

13.3 Types of Data

Data can be primarily divided into two types – qualitative data and quantitative data. Qualitative data only describes an item example coconut tree, palm tree, etc or language spoken – Tamil, Telugu, Hindi, English, etc. Quantitative data on the other hand has numerical value to the item, example, marks obtained - 45, 70, 60, 90, 25, etc.

Data can also be divided based on the source or method of collection as the primary data and secondary data. The primary data are those statistical materials which the investigator collects by going from door to door for the purpose of his/her study. On the other hand, the secondary data refer to already collected and recorded data which the investigator had collected from published or unpublished sources.

13.4 Methods of collection of Data

Methods of Primary data collection

1. Direct personal investigation (interview)
2. Indirect oral investigation
3. Questionnaire Method

Methods of Secondary data collection

1. Published Sources
2. Unpublished Sources

13.5 Organisation and Classification of Data

After collecting data it has to be classified and arranged for further statistical analysis. The data classified is large in quantity needs to be reduced for further analysis. This leads to organization of data.

Following steps are important in organization of data

Finding Range

While organizing the data, it is necessary to find out the highest and lowest number (maximum and minimum value) from the given data. The difference between these two extreme values is called range.

Range = Highest value – Lowest value.

Example

Find out the range from the following data 2, 6, 4, 9, 12, 8, 5, 8. In this case, highest value is 12 and lowest value is 2, and the range is 12 – 2 = 10.

Frequency array

In statistics, array refers to some kind of orderly arrangement. When the numerical raw data is arranged in ascending or descending order, it is called array.

Frequency distribution

It is an arrangement of data into classes. Following technical terms are important for frequency distribution.

1. Class

It is a group which divides the variable into parts and forms a set of given frequency.

Example

CLASS INTERVAL	TALLY	FREQUENCY
0-10	|	1
10-20	𝍸	5
20-30	𝍸 𝍸 ||	12
30-40	𝍸 |||	8
40-50	||||	4
	SUM	30

2. Class limit

The extreme values of the classes or groups are called the class limit. Each class has lower limit (minimum value) and upper limit (maximum value).

For example in the class 10 – 20, the lower limit is 10 and upper limit is 20.

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